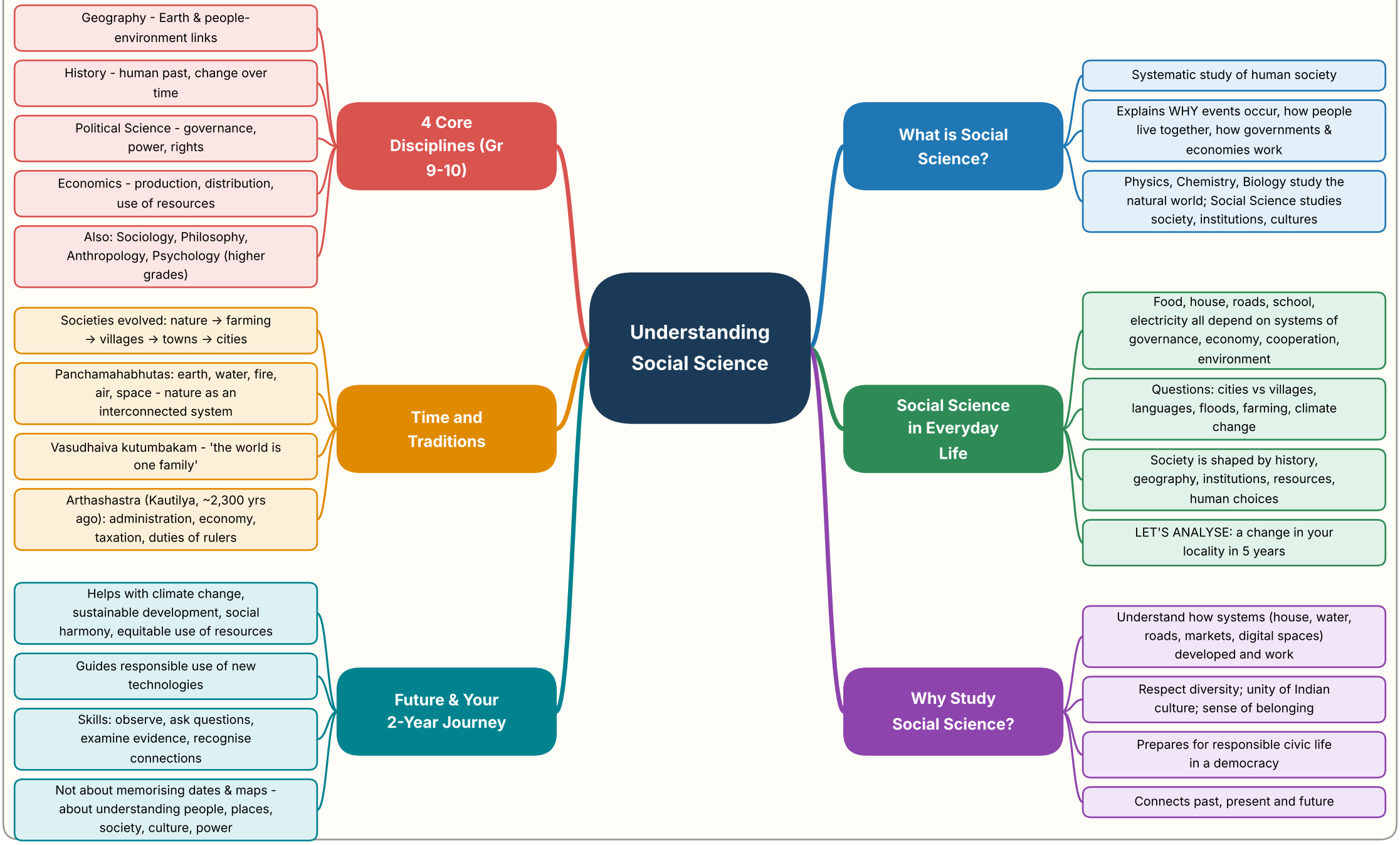
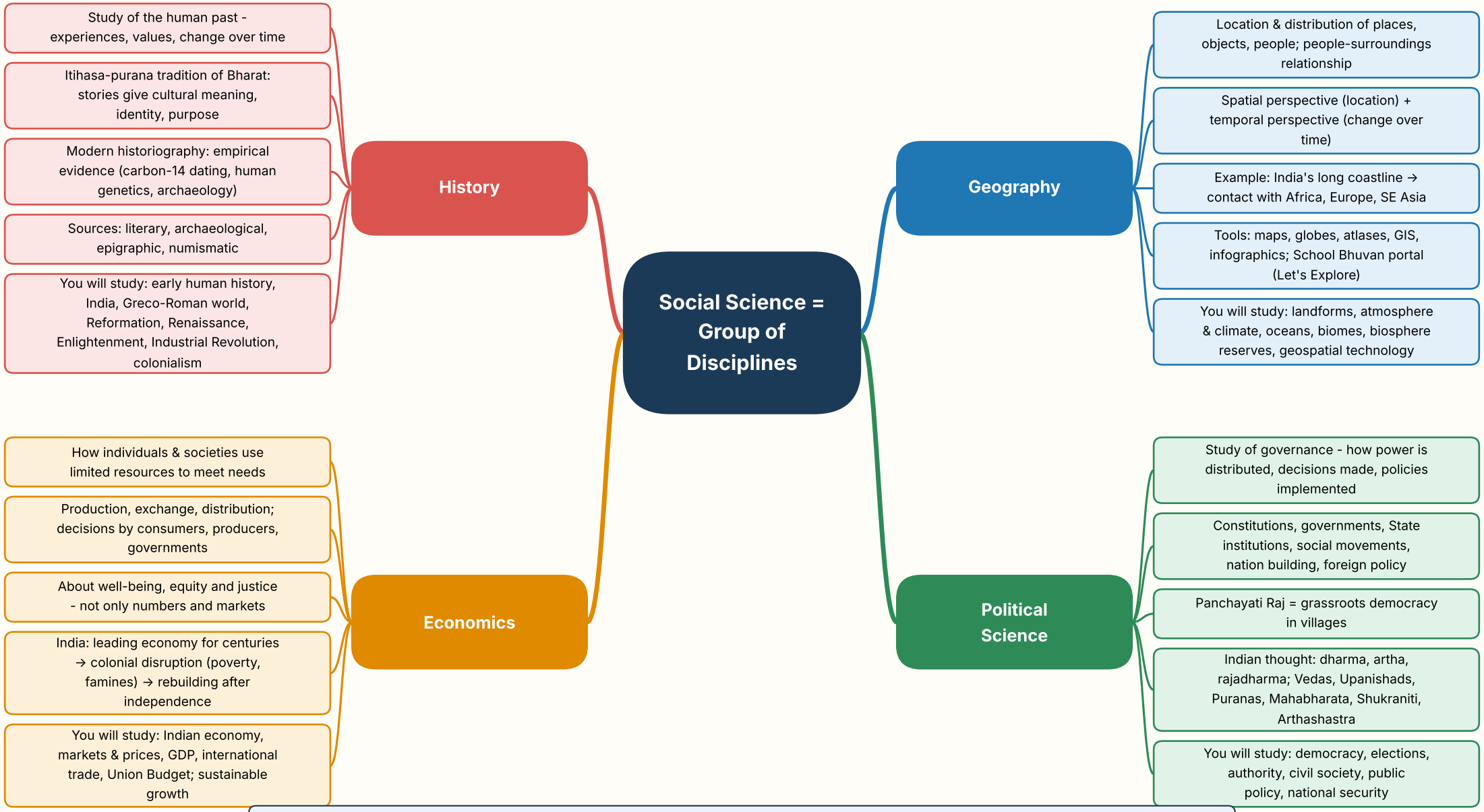
Mind Map 1: Understanding Social Science (Chapter Overview)

Class 9 Social Science | Understanding Society: India and Beyond (Part 1) | Chapter 1



Mind Map 2: The Four Core Disciplines

Class 9 Social Science | Understanding Society: India and Beyond (Part 1) | Chapter 1



Drought example: crops (environment) + farmers' incomes (economy) + relief measures (politics) + migration (society) + coping ways (culture)

Mind Map 3: Sources of History

Class 9 Social Science | Understanding Society: India and Beyond (Part 1) | Chapter 1

Sources of History

Archaeological Sources

- Material remains: monuments, architectural structures, excavated sites, artefacts, objects, art
- Sculptures and paintings included
- Analysed with scientific instruments and laboratory testing
- Fig 1.4: Terracotta figurine, Sindhu-Sarasvati Civilisation
- Fig 1.5: Sculpture of Vishnu, 12th century CE

Numismatic Sources

- Coins, currency, medals
- Reveal economy, chronology, rulers, trade, political boundaries, culture (metal, inscriptions, symbols)
- Fig 1.8: Coin of King Samudragupta, 4th century CE
- Fig 1.9: Mughal coin of Jahangir with zodiac sign Sagittarius

Modern Historiography

- Relies increasingly on empirical evidence - information from actual observation or experimentation
- Tools: human genetics, carbon-14 dating, archaeology, other scientific methods
- Used to establish timelines and understand the past
- Evidence from multiple sources → explanations supported by evidence

Literary Sources

- Travelogues, memoirs, correspondence
- Genealogical records (family lineage; births, marriages, deaths)
- Folklore, oral traditions, revenue documents
- Fig 1.2: Samaveda manuscript (National Museum, New Delhi)
- Fig 1.3: Palm-leaf manuscript of the Tirukkural - ancient Tamil text of ethical wisdom

Epigraphic Sources

- Texts, decrees, records inscribed on stone, metal plates, rock surfaces
- Direct evidence about past events, rulers, administration, society
- Fig 1.6: Brahmi inscription on a Gupta-period pillar
- Fig 1.7: Kannada inscription of Krishnadeva Raya, Prasanna Virupaksha Temple, Hampi

Traditions of History

- Multiple ways to interpret the past & pass cultural values across generations
- Itihasa-purana: preserves cultural memory through stories; reinforces ideals and values
- Some traditions stress moral & philosophical insight; others documentary verification